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Blog

21st Century Johnny Appleseed – A Carbon-Negative Trek Across America

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On August 26th, New York resident and enthusiastic electric vehicle owner Brian Kent will set out on a 100-day trek across the nation. But what makes this road trip different than others is his intent to make it, as he says, “Negative Carbon (<http://on.fb.me/1MvOQNj>).”

Kent plans to drive his Nissan Leaf to each of the 48 contiguous states during his 100 days on the road. And as he travels to each state he plans to plant a tree. Essentially, taking what would be a carbon-neutral trip and turning it into a voyage that wholly benefits the planet.

Kent offers the comparison to John Chapman, better known as Johnny Appleseed, the nomadic nurseryman who trekked through the frontier and planted apple seeds along much of Pennsylvania, Ohio, Indiana, Illinois and West Virginia. But the scope of Kent’s travels dwarfs that of Chapman’s, and perhaps that’s the point.

A voyage spanning all contiguous 48 states!

In preparation of his journey, Kent established a Facebook page to track his journey and started an IndieGoGo page for those who wish to contribute and influence his time on the road. For a certain sum of money a contributor can augment a number of variables on Kent's proposed 25,000 mile odyssey around the country.

"Every dollar pledged to this project will help reduce carbon pollution. Every dollar will be spent toward planting good-quality, hardy, long-lived, climate-appropriate trees," Kent explains (<http://bit.ly/1JpXuLo>) on his IndieGoGo funding page. And with a larger sum pledged, a donor can dictate the size and number of trees that Kent plants along his journey.

With a generous thousand dollar donation, someone can dictate where within a state Kent will travel to plant a tree, provided it complies with legal guidelines and property ownership. So if you wish to have Kent drive to your residence and plant a tree, it'll set you back a cool grand.



Where is he getting these trees?

Kent notes that he will source the trees, as often as he can, from the Arbor Day Foundation. Since the trees will not be traveling with Kent in his Nissan Leaf, he will need to coordinate deliveries along his route.

The trees planted in each state will take into consideration the climate and soil conditions therein. By selecting indigenous plants for each climate, Kent intends for these trees to last in their new homes. He isn't using this as some quick and cheap publicity stunt. He appears to care a great deal about the trees remaining and thriving.

Takeaway

Kent intends to make this voyage an annual event, and seeing that he's already hit 68% of his funding goal after only 11 days, he might be able to make that a reality! Kent will set out on his journey, planting trees along the way, on August 26.

